



SEBI Grade A English

Previous Year Paper

Phase 1

2020-2025

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Preface

Dear Students,

We are pleased to present this recollected question paper with answer keys for the **SEBI Grade A English** subject, covering the past six years **from 2020 to 2025(Exam held 4 times)**. This document has been meticulously prepared to serve as a valuable resource for candidates preparing for the SEBI Grade A Phase 1 Exam.

By practising questions that have been actually asked in the examination, aspirants can gain clarity on the **exam pattern, difficulty level, and types of questions** likely to appear in the upcoming exam.

We wish you all the best in your exam preparation journey and hope that this document serves as a valuable asset in strengthening your performance and confidence.

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Disclaimer: While every effort has been made to ensure the accuracy and relevance of the questions and answer keys, minor variations in question wording or options may exist due to the memory-based nature of this compilation. Candidates are advised to use this document as a reference tool to enhance their comprehensive understanding of the syllabus and overall exam readiness for the SEBI Grade A examination.



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SEBI Grade A 2020 Phase 1 - English Recollected Questions

English

Directions (1-4): Identify the words that are *similar in meaning* to the phrase in bold. If none of option conveys the correct meaning, mark (E) as your answer. The options do not necessarily need to be grammatically correct.

Q1. He spoke with the fervour of discovery, unaware that he was reinventing the wheel.

- A. Wasting time
- B. Construct a wheel
- C. Repeating thoughts
- D. Growing continuously
- E. None of these

Q2. They allowed him to save face by accepting his resignation.

- A. Enhance dignity
- B. Avoid humiliation
- C. Reverse the decision
- D. make it difficult
- E. None of the above

Q3. Agriculture stocks gained ground after the finance minister proposed to raise institutional credit for agriculture to Rs.11 lakh crore for 2018-19.

- A. Increase in quantity
- B. Become Popular
- C. Lose momentum
- D. Market capitalization
- E. None of the above

Q4. When he heard the bad news, he kept a stiff upper lip.

- A. Stoic demeanour
- B. Emotional outburst
- C. Physical injury
- D. Agitated state
- E. None of the above

Directions (5-9): Rearrange the following six sentences A, B, C, D, E, and F in the proper sequence to form a meaningful paragraph and then answer the question given beside.

- A. In dualistic thinking, students typically tend to depend on figures of authority as benchmarks on what is right or wrong rather than analysing facts.
- B. An understanding and realization of this model could enable students to develop intellectually beyond the level.
- C. His concept of dualistic thinking in his model of intellectual development involving nine levels, published in 1970.
- D. Perry's model today remains part of college teaching systems in many western contexts.
- E. William G. Perry was a well-known educational psychologist who studied the cognitive development of students during their college years.

- F. Dualism refers to the first level of intellectual capacity, to understand good and evil in black and white, sans intervening shades.

Q5. Which of the following would be the FOURTH sentence after rearrangement?

- A. E
- B. F
- C. D
- D. B
- E. A

Q6. Which of the following would be the LAST sentence after rearrangement?

- A. E
- B. D
- C. F
- D. C
- E. A

Q7. Which of the following would be the FIRST sentence after rearrangement?

- A. A
- B. C
- C. F
- D. E
- E. D

Q8. Which of the following would be the SECOND sentence after rearrangement?

- A. B
- B. F
- C. C
- D. D
- E. E

Q9. Which of the following would be the THIRD sentence after rearrangement?

- A. F
- B. A
- C. C
- D. E
- E. B

Direction (10): In the following questions, a sentence has been broken into parts. Identify the parts, which are correct in terms of grammar, spelling and logical consistency. Then choose the most appropriate answer.

Q10. A. The worse attack on this peacekeeping

B. mission is a tragic reminder

C. of how this conflict is

D. spiralling out of control.

- A. A & B
- B. A, B & D
- C. A, B & C
- D. B, C & D
- E. All are correct

Direction (11-12): In the following questions, two related sentences I and II are given. There may be an error in the sentence(s). You have to find the error and then select the correct option from those given after the sentences.

Q11. I. Yellowstone National Park is the oldest national park in the US and likely the world.

II. Anyone can drive through the park and encounter an array of wildlife a few feet away.

- A. If there is an error only in the first sentence.
- B. If there is an error only in the second sentence.
- C. If there are errors in both sentences
- D. If there is an error in either of the sentences
- E. If there is no error in either of the sentences

Q12. I. The Amazon River is the artery for the largest rainforest in the world.

II. It is the largest river in the world by discharge and one of the larger one by length.

- A. If there is an error only in the first sentence.
- B. If there is an error only in the second sentence.
- C. If there are errors in both sentences
- D. If there is an error in either of the sentences
- E. If there is no error in either of the sentences

Direction (13-15): In the questions given below, a blank has been provided for each and needs to be filled with the appropriate word. Choose the best option among the given ones.

Q13. Even though India has become world's second largest mobile phone manufacturer in the world after china, it is also _____ for simply bringing in most of the components and assembling them, an activity also sarcastically termed as screwdriver technology.

- A. Denuded
- B. Derided
- C. Lauded
- D. Simulated
- E. Exalted

Q14. Alcohol-induced liver damage is a growing epidemic, especially in Kerala where aberrant lifestyle changes are being _____ at a rapid rate as compared to rest of India.

- A. Exhume
- B. Entwined
- C. Tangible
- D. Imbibed
- E. Foresight

Q15. Delhi is the _____ example of a city that has neglected its environment and needs a fundamental policy change incorporating environmental preservation within the economic goals so as to shift the mindset of Indian society.

- A. Quintessential
- B. Banal
- C. Flawed
- D. Primitive
- E. Spirit

Directions (16-20): Read the passage given below and answer the questions that follow.

Energy sector is dominated by traditional energy sources, comprising primarily of oil, gas and coal. These constitute about 85 per cent of India's total energy consumption, followed by renewable energy, which takes care of about 13 per cent of the pie. This trend is fast changing, as government is shifting its focus from traditional sources to cleaner and renewable sources of energy.

In a bid to reduce emissions, the Supreme Court had banned the sale and registration of non-BS-IV compliant vehicles with effect from 1 April 2017. The government has been encouraging development of electric vehicles (EVs) for the Indian market. This paradigm shift towards electric vehicles is going to be a game-changer for the Indian economy in general and our energy sector in particular, as it will curtail demand for oil and gas in the long run. India, being a net importer of crude oil at present, is expected to benefit immensely from the ongoing shift towards electric vehicles. Also, this shift is expected to strengthen India's fiscal position in the years to come.

While companies are waiting for more clarity on the policy front, many corporates have already started investing in the development of technologies and infrastructure for electric vehicles. Several auto companies have aggressively scheduled product launches of electric vehicles over the next five years. The government has plans to make India a 100 percent electric vehicle nation by 2030 and, transport authorities across states have shown their keen interest in rolling out electric bus services.

India is the world's third largest producer of electricity, with a total installed capacity of 329 GW as of 31 August 2017. Thermal energy, comprising coal, gas and diesel power, constitutes about two thirds of the total installed capacity, followed by renewable energy and nuclear power, comprising about a 31 percent and 2 percent share in the pie respectively.

During the last few years, the power sector in India has been witnessing major changes, with the government promoting cleaner energy, such as wind, solar and hydropower, among others, in a bid to provide rapid electrification to the entire country. There is a sharp increase in the capacity additions in the renewable energy space. On the other hand, the fossil energy space has been witnessing a sharp slowdown in capacity additions, as is seen in the statistics of April-August 2017. Only 3,790 MW of fresh capacity was added during the period, as against a targeted addition of 14,956 mw for 2017-18.

The outlook for new capacities in the thermal power space looks bleak, as there are no fresh long term power purchase agreements signed. Additionally, there is a sharp fall in the tariffs for renewable energy, competing aggressively with thermal power tariffs. To reduce its dependence on coal mining, India's largest coal mining company, Coal India, too has announced its intention to diversify into mining of other minerals such as bauxite, nickel, iron ore, etc.

Tariffs for wind and solar energy, which used to be prohibitively high a few years back, are now seen competing strongly with thermal power. Solar power tariffs were R2.65-3.36 per unit last month for 500 MW capacities, as compared to the all-time low tariffs of R2.44 per unit in May 2017. Wind power tariffs have fallen to a record low of Rs 2.64 per unit in the auction conducted by SECI for 1 GW capacities. The government aims to bring power tariffs to R3 per unit, irrespective of the source in the medium term.

The popularity of electric vehicles is all set to rise, with power tariffs becoming more affordable – driven by an increase in renewable power capacities. The development of improved technologies and supporting infrastructure facilities will further push demand for electric vehicles in the country. A clear shift from subsidized fuel towards low-priced clean energy is expected now, which ought to be beneficial for the country. The share of oil, gas and coal in India's energy sector is expected to fall, while the share of cleaner and renewable energy is expected to rise in the years to come.

Q16. Choose the word/group of words which is MOST SIMILAR in meaning to the word/group of words printed in bold as used in the passage.

Prohibitively

- A. Incompletely
- B. In extreme
- C. Blandly
- D. Uncomfortably
- E. Passionately

Q17. Choose the word/group of words which is MOST SIMILAR in meaning to the word/group of words printed in bold as used in the passage.

Bleak

- A. Cheerful
- B. Appealing
- C. Warm
- D. Austere
- E. Vivacious

Q18. What recent changes have been observed in India's power sector?

- I. In terms of capacity addition, increase in addition at a decreasing rate has been seen in renewable energy space.
- II. Government has been actively promoting cleaner energy, such as wind, solar and hydropower.
- III. Tariffs for wind and solar energy are still prohibitively high and would take some time before being able to compete with thermal power effectively.

- A. Only I
- B. Only II
- C. Only I and II
- D. Only II and III
- E. None of the above

Q19. Which of the following, if true, could give a fillip to EVS in India?

- I. Power tariffs decrease owing to increase in power generation capacity.
- II. The government provides subsidies on clean energy and taxes conventional fuels.
- III. Spreading awareness about the advantages EVS have over non-EVS.

- A. Only I
- B. Only II
- C. Only III
- D. Only I and II
- E. All of the above

Q20. Which of the following is/are true with reference to the passage?

- I. Energy sector is dominated by traditional non renewable energy sources.
- II. Shift towards Electric vehicles will lead to more consumption of oil and gas in the long run.
- III. Reduction in the use of oil and gas will lessen India's imports and improve fiscal numbers.

- A. Only I
- B. Only II
- C. Only I and III
- D. Only II and III
- E. All of the above

**SEBI Grade A 2020
Phase 1 - English
Recollected Questions
Answer Key**

Answer Key

Question	Answer	Question	Answer	Question	Answer
1	A	2	B	3	B
4	A	5	E	6	B
7	D	8	C	9	A
10	D	11	C	12	B
13	B	14	D	15	A
16	B	17	D	18	B
19	E	20	C		

SEBI Grade A 2022 Phase 1 - English Recollected Questions

English

Directions (1-10): Read the passage given below and answer the questions that follow.

A primitive seabird that prospered about 85 million years ago along the warm, shallow inland sea that once split North America boasted what scientists are calling a surprising blend of traits from its dinosaur ancestors and modern **avian** characteristics. Four new fossils of Ichthyornis, which had both a beak and teeth and lived a lifestyle like modern gulls, offer striking evidence of this Cretaceous Period bird's important position in avian evolutionary history, researchers said on May 2. While Ichthyornis fossils were first unearthed in the 1870s, the new ones from Kansas and Alabama chalk deposits, including a beautifully preserved skull, reveal far more about it than previously known.

Birds evolved from small, feathered dinosaurs. Unlike the earliest-known birds like Archaeopteryx, which lived 150 million years ago, Ichthyornis was a strong flier, its body streamlined, simplified and adapted for the flight like modern birds, Yale University paleontologist Bhart-Anjan Bhullar said. Its primitive characteristics were largely in its skull. "Despite the modernity of its body and wings, it retained almost a full complement of dinosaurian teeth, and it had a strong bite with large, dinosaurian jaw muscles. However, it perceived its world and thought like a bird, with a bird's enormous eyes and expanded modern-looking brain", Bhullar added.

While older primitive birds like Confuciusornis, from 125 million years ago, sported a beak, the small one on Ichthyornis was the first known to have modern attributes like a 'pincer tip' for grasping, pecking and fine manipulation. "Its sharp teeth probably would have assisted in holding onto slippery marine prey, while the incipient beak at the tips of its jaws probably would have allowed it to manipulate objects with fine dexterity such as modern birds can do, and **preen** its feathers", University of Bath paleontologist Daniel Field said.

Ichthyornis was the size of a tern, with a two-foot wingspan, and probably ate fish and shellfish. It shared the skies with flying reptiles called pterosaurs when dinosaurs dominated the land. Toothed birds vanished along with the dinosaurs and many other species after an asteroid impact 66 million years ago. Fossils like those of Ichthyornis and Cretaceous toothed diving bird Hesperornis were cited by 19th-century naturalist Charles Darwin as strong support for his theory of evolution. "Ichthyornis shows the ways in which evolution is both complex and elegant, permissive of individual changes and massive integrated transformations," Bhullar said.

Q1. To which species does Pterosaurs belongs to?

- A. Seabird
- B. Flying reptiles
- C. Dinosaurs
- D. Diving bird
- E. Feathered dinosaur

Q2. Who among the following did not give the Theory of Evolution?

- i. Charles Darwin
 - ii. Bhart-Anjan Bhullar
 - iii. Daniel Field
- A. Only i
 - B. All except i
 - C. All except ii
 - D. All except iii
 - E. All i, ii and iii

Q3. The above passage is likely to be extracted from a _____?

- I. Scientific magazine
 - II. Newspaper
 - III. Journal
- A. Only i
 - B. All except i
 - C. All except ii
 - D. All except iii
 - E. All i, ii and iii

Q4. Toothed birds vanished along with the dinosaurs and many other species after an _____ ago.

- A. asteroid impact 66 million years
- B. asteroid impact 125 million years
- C. asteroid impact 125 billion years
- D. asteroid impact 85 million years
- E. asteroid impact 66 trillion years

Q5. When did the Ichthyornis fossils were first unearthed?

- A. 85 million years ago
- B. 125 million years ago
- C. on May 2
- D. in 1870s
- E. 66 million years ago

Q6. Which among the following species had its primitive characteristics largely in its skull?

- A. Archaeopteryx
- B. Hesperornis
- C. Confuciusornis
- D. Pterosaurs
- E. Ichthyornis

Q7. As used in the last paragraph, what do you understand by the word 'preen'?

- A. Clean
- B. Pity
- C. Pure
- D. Tear
- E. Fear

Q8. Ichthyornis have a wingspan of?

- A. 2 foot
- B. 2 inches
- C. 2 metres
- D. 2 centimetres
- E. 2 millimetres

Q9. The tone of the author in reference to the above passage is?

- A. Informative
- B. Doubtful
- C. Controversial
- D. Mocking
- E. Criticising

Q10. As used in the first paragraph, 'avian' is used in what reference?

- A. Relating to artists
- B. Relating to birds
- C. Relating to aliens
- D. Relating to human species
- E. Relating to insects

Q11. Directions: In the following question, one part of the sentence may have an error. Find out which part of the sentence has an error and click the button corresponding to it. If the sentence is free from error, click the "No error" option.

Climate Change in Glasgow, scheduled later this (A)/ year, is to come down with a domestic climate (B)/ plan that explains to the citizen how it will bring (C)/ green development in this decade, specifying a target by sector for each year. (D)/ No error /(E)

- A. A
- B. B
- C. C
- D. D
- E. No error

Q12. Read the following sentence and determine whether there is any error in it. The error, if any, will be in one part of the sentence. If the sentence is error-free, then select 'No Error' as your

Bringing clean renewable energy to low-income countries(A)/ would enable more women and girls to gain access(B)/ to education, as without electricity they often(C)/ lack the means to study after nightfall. (D)

- A. A
- B. B
- C. C
- D. D
- E. No error

Q13. Read the following sentence and determine whether there is any error in it. The error, if any, will be in one part of the sentence. If the sentence is error-free, then select 'No Error' as your The discovery of two new species of dinosaurs, (A)/ namely Ceratosuchops inferodios and Riparovenator milnerae, which likely(B)/ roamed the south of England 125 million(C)/ years ago, have shed new light on the predators. (D)

- A. A
- B. B
- C. C
- D. D
- E. No Error

Q14. Read the following sentence and determine whether there is an error in it. The error, if any, will be in one part of the sentence. If the sentence is error-free, then select 'No Error' as your

The diameter of a single, cylindrical DNA (A)/ component is always the same, (B)/ regardless to whether it forms part (C)/ of a fruit fly, or a beech tree. (D)

- A. A
- B. B
- C. C
- D. D
- E. No error

Q15 Read the sentence below to find out if there is any error in it. The error, if any, will be in one part of the sentence. The letter of that part is the answer. If there is no error the answer is (5).(Ignore errors in punctuation if any).

Their most significant gains (A)/have been in the north half of the country, (B)/a traditional stronghold of the U.S.allied (C)/ warlords who helped defeat them in 2001(D)/ No Error (E)

- A. A
- B. B
- C. C
- D. D
- E. E

Direction (Q.16-20): Read the given sentences and arrange them in a coherent and logical order. Answer the questions that follow.

- A. Over the past year, perceptions of relative U.S. economic power have declined in many of America's key trading partners and allies.
- B. Following the onset of the financial crisis nearly a decade ago, Europeans increasingly named China, rather than the U.S., as the world's leading economic power.
- C. This year, however, the pattern has reversed itself again, and in countries such as Germany, the United Kingdom, and Spain, China is once more seen as occupying the top spot.
- D. But in recent years, as the American economy slowly recovered, the pendulum began to swing back in the direction of the U.S.
- E. The trend can be seen in several European countries, where views about the economic balance of power have fluctuated in recent years.

Q16. Which of the following is the FIRST statement?

- A. A
- B. B
- C. C
- D. D
- E. E

Q17. Which of the following is the SECOND statement?

- A. A
- B. B
- C. C
- D. D
- E. E

Q18. Which of the following is the THIRD statement?

- A. A
- B. B
- C. C
- D. D
- E. E

Q19. Which of the following is the Fourth statement?

- A. A
- B. B
- C. C
- D. D
- E. E

Q20. Which of the following is the FIFTH statement?

- A. A
- B. B
- C. C
- D. D
- E. E



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**SEBI Grade A 2022
Phase 1 - English
Recollected Questions
Answer Key**

English

Question	Answer	Question	Answer	Question	Answer
1	B	2	B	3	D
4	A	5	D	6	E
7	A	8	A	9	A
10	B	11	B	12	E
13	D	14	C	15	B
16	A	17	E	18	B
19	D	20	C		

SEBI Grade A 2024 Phase 1 - English Recollected Questions

English

Direction (1-7): Read the passage carefully then answer the questions given below.

The presence of humans on Earth has significantly transformed the natural environment in numerous and complex ways. From the rapid development of sprawling urban areas to extensive deforestation, human activities have exerted profound and often detrimental impacts on various ecosystems. The advent of industrialization, marked by the extensive use of machinery and energy resources, has led to the widespread alteration of landscapes and a notable loss of natural habitats for countless species. This transformation is evident in the loss of forests, wetlands, and grasslands, which were once teeming with diverse flora and fauna.

Urban expansion has further exacerbated environmental degradation. As cities grow, they encroach upon previously undisturbed areas, fragmenting natural habitats and reducing the available space for wildlife. This encroachment not only contributes to habitat loss but also increases pollution levels, as the demand for resources and waste production rise. Air pollution, resulting from industrial emissions and vehicular exhaust, has severely impacted air quality, leading to health problems for both humans and animals. Similarly, water pollution from industrial runoff, agricultural practices, and improper waste disposal has compromised the quality of water resources, affecting aquatic life and human health.

Climate change, driven primarily by the emission of greenhouse gases such as carbon dioxide and methane, compounds these environmental challenges. The accumulation of these gases in the atmosphere leads to global warming, which disrupts established weather patterns and increases the frequency and severity of extreme weather events. Hurricanes, floods, droughts, and heatwaves are becoming more common and intense, posing significant risks to ecosystems, agriculture, and human settlements.

Despite technological advancements and a growing awareness of environmental issues, the challenge of reconciling human progress with the need for environmental conservation remains urgent and complex. Efforts to mitigate environmental impacts include promoting sustainable practices, investing in renewable energy sources, and enhancing conservation efforts. However, achieving a balance between development and environmental protection requires ongoing commitment, innovative solutions, and a collaborative approach across various sectors of society.

Q1. What is a primary consequence of industrialization according to the passage?

- A. Increased biodiversity
- B. Improved air quality
- C. Habitat loss for many species
- D. Decreased greenhouse gas emissions
- E. Enhanced water resources

Q2. How has urban expansion impacted the environment?

- A. It has reduced pollution levels.
- B. It has led to increased biodiversity.
- C. It has contributed to habitat loss and increased pollution.
- D. It has improved water quality.
- E. It has stabilized weather patterns.

Q3. Which of the following is NOT mentioned as a challenge in the passage?

- A. Climate change
- B. Air pollution
- C. Decreased technological advancements
- D. Water pollution
- E. Extreme weather events

Q4. What effect does climate change have on weather patterns?

- A. It stabilizes weather patterns.
- B. It reduces the frequency of extreme weather events.
- C. It alters weather patterns and increases the frequency of extreme weather events.
- D. It makes weather patterns more predictable.
- E. It leads to a decrease in global temperatures.

Q5. Which of the following words is closest in meaning to "transformed" as used in the passage?

- A. Preserved
- B. Altered
- C. Repaired
- D. Neglected
- E. Maintained

Q6. Which of the following words is the antonym of "degradation" as used in the passage?

- A. Decline
- B. Destruction
- C. Improvement
- D. Deterioration
- E. Breakdown

Q7. What does the passage suggest is a major challenge in balancing human progress with environmental conservation?

- A. Increased technological innovations
- B. Enhanced species diversity
- C. Climate change and its impacts
- D. Improved air quality
- E. Greater energy consumption

Directions (8-12): Each question below has one blank, which is indicating that something has been omitted. Find out which option can be used to fill up the blank in the sentence in the same sequence to make it meaningfully complete.

Q8. Homemade gifts can be completely _____ to what the recipient likes.

- A. Alters
- B. Firmed
- C. Tailored
- D. Polite
- E. Liability

Q9. After much thought, Ted _____ not to travel abroad this summer.

- A. Resolved
- B. Concludes
- C. Resolves
- D. Commence
- E. Passed

Q10. Bryan is _____ in his belief that the earth is flat.

- A. Tentative
- B. Hasten
- C. Unlikely
- D. Provided
- E. Confident

Q11. The noodle maker was _____ in making his noodles and would never let another person take over the task.

- A. Careless
- B. Negligent
- C. Cautious
- D. Exciting
- E. Inattentive

Q12. If it weren't for the _____ circumstances, he would have certainly lost his job.

- A. Sharp
- B. Intensify
- C. Mitigating
- D. Increase
- E. Aggravate

Directions (13-16): In each of the questions given below four words are given in bold. These four words may or may not be in their correct position. The sentence is then followed by options with the correct combination of words that should replace each other in order to make the sentence grammatically and contextually correct. Find the correct combination of the words that replace each other. If the sentence is correct as it then select option (E. as your choice).

Q13. Some American officials **lead** (A) to hope that **resumed** (B) sanctions on Iran will **appear** (C) to a popular **uprising** (D)

- A. A-B
- B. A-C
- C. B-D and A-C
- D. A-D
- E. The sentence is correct

Q14. **Tariffs** (A) has **imported** (B) higher **China** (C) on 603 items **imposed** (D) from the US.

- A. Only A-B
- B. Only B-C
- C. Both A-B and B-D
- D. Both A-C and B-D.
- E. The sentence is correct.

Q15. NATO ally **world** (A) leads the **Turkey** (B) in the **journalists** (C) of **number** (D) jailed.

- A. A-B and C-D
- B. Only B-C
- C. A-C and B-D
- D. A-D
- E. The sentence is correct.

Q16. In 2016, **rising** (A) violence in **Pathankot** (B) by Islamic militants **culminated** C. in attacks on Indian forces at Uri and **Kashmir** (D)

- A. Both A-C and B-D
- B. Both A-D and B-C
- C. Only B-D.
- D. C-D
- E. The sentence is correct.

Direction (17-20): Read each sentence to find out whether there is any grammatical or idiomatic error in it. The error, if any, will be in one part of the sentence. The number of that part is the answer. If there is 'No error', the answer is (E) (Ignore errors of punctuation, if any.)

Q17. She held something (A) / at her side which (B) / was totally hiding (C) / by the folds of her sari. (D) / No error. (E).

- A. A
- B. B
- C. C
- D. D
- E. E

Q18. The father forbade his son (A) / to walk in the sun (B) / and play with (C) / his friends on the road (D)/ No error (E)

- A. A
- B. B
- C. C
- D. D
- E. E

Q19. The movement, which aims to (A) / raise awareness about climate change, hopes (B) / to bring people together to think about (C) / what they can do for reduce harmful pollution. (D) / No error (E)

- A. A
- B. B
- C. C
- D. D
- E. E

Q20. I declined the invitation (A) / not because I did not (B) / want to go but (C) / because I have no time (D) / No error (E)

- A. A
- B. B
- C. C
- D. D
- E. E

**SEBI Grade A 2024
Phase 1 - English
Recollected Questions
Answer Key**

Answer Key

Question	Answer	Question	Answer	Question	Answer
1	C	2	C	3	C
4	C	5	B	6	C
7	C	8	C	9	A
10	E	11	C	12	C
13	B	14	D	15	A
16	C	17	C	18	E
19	D	20	D		

SEBI Grade A 2025 Phase 1 - English Recollected Questions

English

Direction (1-5): Read the passage carefully then answer the questions given below.

For decades, scientists have tried to determine whether Mars once had conditions suitable for life. While the planet today is cold, dry, and exposed to intense radiation, geological evidence suggests that early Mars may have been warmer and wetter. One key factor influencing planetary habitability is the presence of a thick atmosphere, which can retain heat and protect the surface from harmful solar winds. Understanding when Mars lost its atmosphere remains a central question in planetary science.

A recent study conducted by researchers at Stanford University revisits this issue using new atmospheric loss models. Published in *Nature Astronomy*, the study argues that Mars may have retained a significant portion of its atmosphere until about 3.6 billion years ago—later than earlier theories that placed atmospheric collapse at around 4.2 billion years ago. This extended atmospheric lifespan could have allowed liquid water to persist on the surface for a longer duration.

The research was led by Dr. Michael Anders, who used computer simulations to model how solar wind interacted with Mars's atmosphere over time. Because Mars lacks a strong global magnetic field today, solar particles are able to strip atmospheric gases directly from the planet. However, the team's simulations suggest that Mars once possessed localized magnetic regions strong enough to slow this atmospheric erosion.

To support their model, the researchers analyzed data from NASA's MAVEN mission, which measures how charged particles escape from Mars's upper atmosphere. The data showed variability in atmospheric loss rates that could be explained by intermittent magnetic shielding in Mars's early history. This finding challenges the assumption that atmospheric loss occurred rapidly and uniformly across the planet.

If Mars retained its atmosphere longer than previously believed, it strengthens the case for sustained surface water and potentially microbial life. Anders emphasizes that planetary environments evolve gradually, and small protective mechanisms—such as partial magnetic shielding—can have large long-term effects. The study highlights the importance of revising long-standing assumptions as new data and modeling techniques become available.

Q1. According to the passage, until approximately when might Mars have retained a significant portion of its atmosphere?

- A. 4.5 billion years ago
- B. 4.2 billion years ago
- C. 3.9 billion years ago
- D. 3.6 billion years ago
- E. 3.0 billion years ago

Q2. What primary method did the Stanford research team use in their study?

- A. Laboratory experiments on Martian soil samples
- B. Observations from surface rovers
- C. Computer simulations of atmospheric loss
- D. Chemical analysis of Martian meteorites
- E. Geological mapping using radar

Q3. What role did localized magnetic regions on Mars play, according to the study?

- A. They completely prevented atmospheric escape
- B. They increased volcanic activity
- C. They slowed the rate of atmospheric erosion
- D. They altered Mars's orbit
- E. They intensified solar radiation

Q4. Which of the following assumptions is directly challenged by the findings of the study?

- A. Mars never had surface water
- B. Atmospheric loss on Mars was rapid and uniform
- C. Mars's surface geology is poorly understood
- D. Solar wind has little effect on planetary atmospheres
- E. Mars's climate was identical to Earth's

Q5. In the passage, the word "intermittent" most nearly means:

- A. Continuous
- B. Regular
- C. Occasional
- D. Permanent
- E. Predictable

Directions (6-8): Each question below has two blanks, which is indicating that something has been omitted. Find out which option can be used to fill up the blanks in the sentence in the same sequence to make it meaningfully complete.

Q6. The author's argument, though _____ in tone, was ultimately _____ by its reliance on unverified anecdotes.

- A. persuasive / strengthened
- B. measured / undermined
- C. aggressive / validated
- D. emotional / supported
- E. confident / clarified

Q7. The judge's remarks were intended to _____ public confidence in the judiciary rather than _____ doubts about its impartiality.

- A. restore / fuel
- B. weaken / resolve
- C. challenge / dismiss
- D. question / clarify
- E. diminish / confirm

Q8. While the technology promises to _____ efficiency in the long run, its immediate impact may _____ existing operational challenges.

- A. compromise / resolve
- B. enhance / exacerbate
- C. stabilise / eliminate
- D. measure / prevent
- E. limit / disguise

Direction (9-10) Each question contains a sentence divided into five parts labeled A, B, C, D, and E, separated by slashes (/). These parts are not in the correct order. Select the option that arranges the parts in the correct sequence to form a clear and grammatically correct sentence.

Q9. Which fundamentally altered (A) / the way individuals consume information today (B) / the rapid rise of social media platforms (C) / has transformed communication patterns (D) / over the past decade (E)

- A. C-D-A-B-E
- B. E-C-D-A-B
- C. C-E-D-B-A
- D. E-C-A-D-B
- E. C-D-E-A-B

Q10. By placing short-term profits above long-term stability (A) / many corporations undermine their own sustainability (B) / even though the consequences are often foreseeable (C) / and eventually erode stakeholder trust (D) / in competitive markets (E)

- A. B-A-E-D-C
- B. E-B-A-D-C
- C. B-E-A-C-D
- D. E-A-B-D-C
- E. B-A-D-E-C

Directions (11-13): In each of the questions given below four words are underlined. These four words may or may not be in their correct position. The sentence is then followed by options with the correct combination of words that should replace each other in order to make the sentence grammatically and contextually correct. Find the correct combination of the words that replace each other. If the sentence is correct as it then select option E. as your choice.

Q11. The scientist (A) dismissed the theory as (B) plausible, while later (C) endorsing an explanation that was (D) untenable under scrutiny.

- A. A-B
- B. A-C
- C. B-D and A-C
- D. B-D
- E. The sentence is correct

Q12.The manager (A) praised the team for their (B) negligent efforts and (C) reprimanded the employees who showed (D) exemplary conduct during the audit.

- A. Only A-B
- B. Only B-D
- C. Both A-B and C-D
- D. Both A-C and B-D.
- E. The sentence is correct.

Q13. The proposal was widely criticised (A) for its latent (B) flaws, which were actually obvious (C) and long overlooked(D).

- A. A-B and C-D
- B. Only B-C
- C. A-C and B-D
- D. A-D
- E. The sentence is correct.

Direction (14) In the following questions, a sentence contains two blanks. Fill the first blank with a suitable sentence starter and the second blank with an appropriate logical connector so that the sentence is grammatically correct and logically coherent. Choose the most appropriate option.

Q14. _____ the economy has shown signs of stabilisation, consumer confidence remains weak; _____, private investment has not picked up.

- A. Although / therefore
- B. Because / however
- C. Although / consequently
- D. Since / moreover
- E. While / hence

Direction(15-17) In each of the following questions, a part of the sentence is underlined. Four alternatives are given below the sentence. Choose the option that best replaces the underlined part and makes the sentence grammatically correct, precise, and contextually appropriate. If no replacement is required, choose (e) No change.

Q15. The committee decided to put a lid on unnecessary expenditure during the financial crisis.

- A. curb down unnecessary expenditure
- B. put a stop to unnecessary expenditure
- C. restrict unnecessary expenditure
- D. bring under control unnecessary expenditure
- E. No change

Q16.The sudden resignation of the CEO threw cold water on the company's expansion plans.

- A. discouraged completely
- B. poured water over
- C. dampened
- D. obstructed heavily
- E. No change

Q17. The proposal was rejected as it failed to stand the test of time.

- A. survive through the years
- B. remain valid in the long run
- C. withstand scrutiny
- D. prove to be durable
- E. No change

Direction (38-40): Read each sentence to find out whether there is any grammatical or idiomatic error in it. The error, if any, will be in one part of the sentence. The number of that part is the answer. If there is 'No error', the answer is (E) (Ignore errors of punctuation, if any.)

Q18. Identify the incorrect sentence.

- A. Mitali's hair is long and black.
- B. Either of the alternatives seem to present major difficulties.
- C. One of the cars in the garage is fifty year old.
- D. Sharon has six brothers.
- E. No error

Q29. Identify the incorrect sentence.

- A. These pieces of jewellery are designed by a highly acclaimed expert.
- B. Elephants can swim very well.
- C. The Nilgiris are the most productive mountains of the south.
- D. There are not many followers of Gandhiji these days.
- E. No error

Q20. Identify the incorrect sentence.

- A. Twenty percent of the population are dependent on agriculture.
- B. Two hours is enough time to complete the examination.
- C. Her guidance was extremely unique during the crisis.
- D. The jury was unanimous in its verdict.
- E. No error

**SEBI Grade A 2025
Phase 1 - English
Recollected Questions
Answer Key**

Answer Key

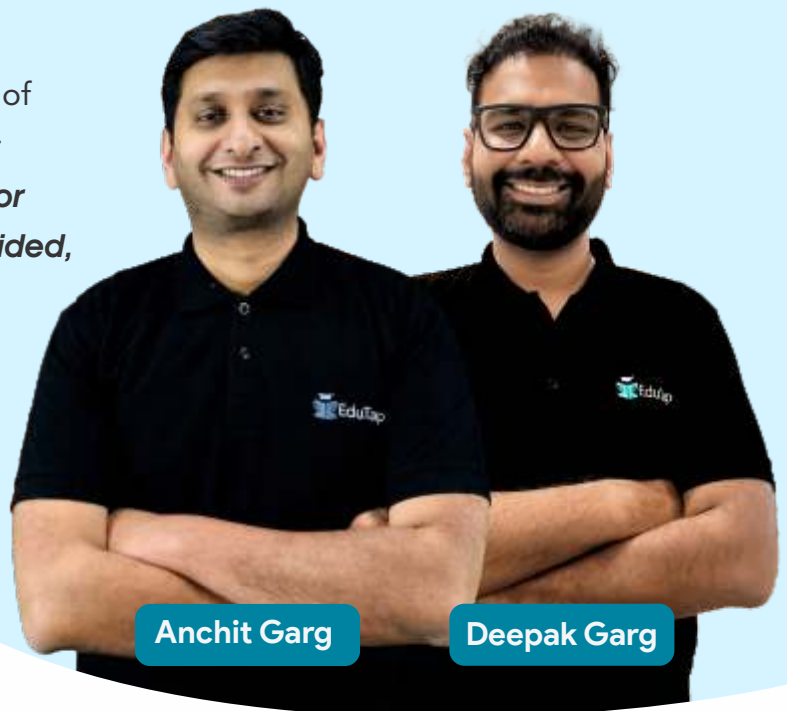
Question	Answer	Question	Answer	Question	Answer
1	D	2	C	3	C
4	B	5	C	6	B
7	A	8	B	9	B
10	C	11	D	12	B
13	B	14	A	15	D
16	C	17	B	18	B
19	A	20	C		

What Next?

- 1. Identify Right Source:** Follow the best study resources (books, online courses, videos, etc.) for each topic on the list. Do not follow multiple sources for the same topic but rather follow good sources multiple times.
- 2. Topic Prioritization:** Review the document to identify key topics that require special attention. Prioritize your study schedule based on the significance of each topic in the syllabus. Ensure a balanced approach, allocating more time to critical subjects.
- 3. Width of Syllabus:** Merely going through the syllabus is not enough; Regularly revisit the document to reassess what topics actually need to be covered.
- 4. Depth of Understanding:** Recognize the varying depths at which topics should be covered. While some concepts demand a broad understanding, others require a more in-depth analysis. Tailor your study approach, accordingly, allocating more time to complex topics that demand deeper comprehension.

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